

Ryan Donovan Burns

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Professional Overview

Highly motivated **Entry-Level Software Developer** with a Master's in Software Development and a strong foundation in Java and JavaScript. Proven ability to **create and improve business processes** through technical solutions, as demonstrated in both academic projects and professional roles. Adept in **full-stack development** using React and Angular, and experienced working within **Agile/Scrum** teams. Seeking to leverage strong problem-solving and collaboration skills to contribute to innovative software initiatives.

Education

- | | |
|--------------------|---|
| 2023
Boston, MA | Boston University <ul style="list-style-type: none">• M.S. Software Development<ul style="list-style-type: none">- Completed multiple team-based, full-stack projects.- Applied Agile principles for real-world scenario coursework.- Graduate Certificate in Web Application Development, 2020 |
| 2007
Boston, MA | Suffolk University <ul style="list-style-type: none">• B.A. Communication & Journalism |

Technical Skills

- **Programming Languages:** JavaScript, Java, Python, TypeScript
- **Front-End:** React, Angular
- **Tools & Methodologies:** Git, Agile (Scrum), JUnit, Pivotal Tracker
- **Databases:** MongoDB, MySQL
- **Cloud:** AWS (basic experience)
- **Additional:** Quality Assurance, Business Process Improvement, Advanced Excel (Conditional Formatting, Formulas)

Relevant Projects

- | | |
|------|--|
| 2020 | Shopping List Application , https://github.com/cs701/MyShoppingList <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Collaborated in a 6-person Agile team to develop a dynamic shopping list tool in Angular.• Served as the primary database architect, selecting and configuring Google Firestore (NoSQL) for real-time data synchronization.• Designed the data schema and security rules, ensuring efficient and secure updates for multiple users. |
| 2022 | E-commerce Website , https://github.com/ryanthekind/rxcellent <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Role: Acted as Scrum Master for a 6-person team in a software engineering course, conducting weekly stand-ups and using Pivotal Tracker to manage sprints and backlogs.• Collaboration: Coordinated task distribution and sprint planning, resolving team conflicts and ensuring milestones were met despite varying commitment levels. |

- **Technical Highlights:** Developed a **React + TypeScript** front-end with responsive design, implemented user authentication, and integrated a REST API for dynamic product listings.
- **Outcome:** Delivered a working **full-stack** e-commerce platform on schedule, earning top marks for project quality and teamwork effectiveness.

Professional Experience

2022 – Present
Boston, MA

Business Process Consultant, *John Hancock*

- Serve on the Anti-Fraud Team to investigate and pursue fraud in insurance claims. Recovered in \$300,000 in avoidance and actuarial savings in January 2025.
- **Optimized** data analysis processes using **advanced Excel** features (conditional formatting, formula automation) to reduce manual review time.
- Partner with cross-functional teams to identify workflow inefficiencies and propose **technical solutions** that enhance fraud detection accuracy.

2021 – 2022
Boston, MA

Quality Assurance Senior Analyst, *John Hancock*

- **Streamlined** large-scale data reconciliation by employing conditional formatting and formulas, expediting the resolution of thousands of lines of claim-related data.
- **Mentored** new team members on best practices for handling and verifying data within spreadsheets.
- Identified and reconciled over ten thousand dollars in uncollected overpayments through advanced spreadsheet logic and data verification.

2011 – 2021
Boston, MA

Quality Assurance Specialist, *John Hancock*

- Supported ongoing process improvements by providing structured feedback to Benefit Specialists and **identifying error trends** to reduce payment inaccuracies.
- Built a reputation as a go-to resource for team members needing help with **technical or data-related** tasks in Excel.